



## speaker test

strict parameters of price. In this category, our award goes to the Umax UPB 3200. This attractive yet unassuming speaker system did what it was meant to do and then some. It produced very good sound, especially for its price — a meagre Rs 1,400 — it offers unbeatable value for money. A sliver away from this amazing deal is the Zebronics Duality 5000. This speaker system is priced at Rs 1,600 and is a great mix of excellent performance, great value and superb looks and is our Editor's choice. Regardless of what sort of 2.1 speaker system you are shopping for, we're certain either of these affordable marvels will more than satisfy. The Artis S-Dual also merits mention though not in the same breath as the previous two. Priced at Rs 2,000, this speaker system sounds good

and looks attractive as well. Perhaps the biggest disappointment here were the big guns — Logitech and Creative both bombed badly in this test proving once and for all that bigger brand names do not necessarily equate to better sounding speakers. Another dud was the Razer Mako. Sure it's a superbly built product and sounds pretty good, but priced at Rs 22,355, we reckon this one is an unworthy indulgence.

### 5.1 SPEAKERS Sound, all around

Surround speakers are the real deal for those looking at buying a speaker system solely for

movies and gaming. This does not mean that a stereo system cannot do well with movies and games, quite the contrary — a really good set of 2.1 speakers will trounce a mediocre 5.1 or even a 6.1 speaker setup. What you miss out on is the accurate positional audio when using a stereo setup. Therefore, if you spend more time gaming and watching movies and need the accurate multi-channel sound staging that a surround sound speaker set provides, then by all means pick up a 5.1 system over a stereo setup. Although 6.1 and even 7.1 sets are available, there are not many video formats around that make use of this standard. Another point to consider is the mess of cables that one needs to deal

| Speakers                                  |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   | 5.1 Surround Speakers                                                             |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Brand                                     | Altec Lansing                                                                     | Logitech                                                                          | Razer                                                                             | Altec Lansing                                                                     | Creative                                                                            | Logitech                                                                            | Logitech                                                                            |
| Model                                     | VS4121                                                                            | Z4                                                                                | Mako                                                                              | VS 3251                                                                           | Inspire T6100                                                                       | X 540                                                                               | Z5500                                                                               |
|                                           |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| Plus (+)                                  | Well built and good looking                                                       | Looks neat                                                                        | Built well, Looks good                                                            | Very good sound quality                                                           | Very good sound                                                                     | Well built, Great Sound                                                             | Amazing for movies, Great Sound                                                     |
| Minus (-)                                 | Slightly expensive                                                                | Flabby bass                                                                       | Flabby bass, super Expensive                                                      | Mediocre looks                                                                    | No digital connects                                                                 | Slightly expensive                                                                  | Very expensive                                                                      |
| Price (Rs)                                | Rs. 4,200                                                                         | Rs. 5,995                                                                         | Rs. 22,355                                                                        | Rs. 5,200                                                                         | Rs. 5,799                                                                           | Rs. 7,145                                                                           | Rs. 27,995                                                                          |
| Grand Totals (Out of 100)                 | 41.35                                                                             | 50.12                                                                             | 52.21                                                                             | 60.64                                                                             | 55.13                                                                               | 54.17                                                                               | 76.39                                                                               |
| Features (Out of 35)                      | 16.03                                                                             | 16.94                                                                             | 16.66                                                                             | 21.35                                                                             | 14.28                                                                               | 12.25                                                                               | 27.90                                                                               |
| Performance (Out of 65)                   | 25.32                                                                             | 33.18                                                                             | 35.55                                                                             | 39.29                                                                             | 40.85                                                                               | 41.92                                                                               | 48.49                                                                               |
| <b>Features</b>                           |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| Controls on Speaker / Remote              |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| Bass / Treble / Volume (Y/N)              | ✓ / ✓ / ✓                                                                         | ✓ / ✗ / ✓                                                                         | ✓ / ✗ / ✓                                                                         | ✓ / ✓ / ✓                                                                         | ✓ / ✗ / ✓                                                                           | ✓ / ✗ / ✓                                                                           | ✓ / ✓ / ✓                                                                           |
| Surround Effects (Y/N)                    | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   |
| Others (List)                             | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   | Source select, Effects                                                              |
| Bundled Accessories                       | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   |
| External Decoder (Y/N)                    | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   | ✓                                                                                   |
| Remote (Wired / Wireless / N)             | ✗                                                                                 | Wired                                                                             | Wired                                                                             | Wireless                                                                          | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   | Wireless                                                                            |
| Built-in FM Tuner (Y/N)                   | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   | ✗                                                                                   |
| Build Quality, buttons / Stands / Overall | 4.5 / 3.5 / 5.5                                                                   | 7.5 / 8.25 / 7.25                                                                 | 6.5 / 6.5 / 9                                                                     | 6 / 3 / 7.25                                                                      | 4.5 / 4.5 / 7                                                                       | 5 / 1.5 / 6                                                                         | 8 / 8.5 / 7.5                                                                       |
| <b>Performance (Scale Of 10)</b>          |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| <b>HD Movie Audio Test</b>                |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| Transformers                              | 3.25                                                                              | 4.25                                                                              | 6                                                                                 | 6.5                                                                               | 7.25                                                                                | 7.75                                                                                | 8.5                                                                                 |
| Star Wars Episode 3                       | 3.25                                                                              | 4.25                                                                              | 5                                                                                 | 6.25                                                                              | 7                                                                                   | 7.25                                                                                | 7.5                                                                                 |
| <b>Music Quality</b>                      |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| Everybody Hurts                           | 4.38                                                                              | 5.25                                                                              | 5.13                                                                              | 5.50                                                                              | 5.86                                                                                | 6.75                                                                                | 7.50                                                                                |
| Tears In Heaven                           | 4.38                                                                              | 5.88                                                                              | 5.13                                                                              | 5.75                                                                              | 5.75                                                                                | 6.00                                                                                | 6.75                                                                                |
| November Rain                             | 4.13                                                                              | 5.63                                                                              | 5.25                                                                              | 6.13                                                                              | 5.50                                                                                | 5.13                                                                                | 7.50                                                                                |
| Money                                     | 4.75                                                                              | 5.75                                                                              | 5.38                                                                              | 5.75                                                                              | 5.88                                                                                | 5.00                                                                                | 7.50                                                                                |
| Selkies The Endless Obsession             | 4.00                                                                              | 5.88                                                                              | 6.38                                                                              | 6.00                                                                              | 5.63                                                                                | 5.88                                                                                | 6.25                                                                                |